



a AI Highlight ▾

Introduction

Trauma can be finished in real life while your body is still doing it. You know you are safe; meanwhile you are bracing, looking for danger, going numb, freezing, collapsing, or suddenly flooded.

That leftover bodily reality is what I mean by somatic here.

With complex or developmental trauma, going straight for the deepest memory is not my first concern.

First: can I stay here when something comes up? Can I stop? Will I more or less be myself afterward? If the answer is no, making the experience overwhelming does not turn it into deep processing.

What comes next depends on what is actually happening. I might need regulation. I might need to let some old survival activation move instead of trying to reason with a body that still thinks the danger is here. Or I might be stable enough to go directly to EMDR or another trauma-focused method. Those are different needs, not steps in a program.

This matters to me for inner-child work in particular. I can know exactly what a younger part needs and still be unable to reach it because everything in me is clenched around the trauma. Sometimes my body has to become a slightly easier place to live before inner-child therapy stops feeling like I am being swallowed by the child-state.

Your Physical State Can Change What Therapy Does

I don't put "therapy" on one side and the physical state of the nervous system doing the therapy on the other. The same session can go very differently depending on sleep, pain, substances or medication, nutrition, fear learning, inflammation, dissociation, glutamate/GABA balance, autonomic tone, or just how physiologically stable I am that day.

I have watched friends get almost nothing from these therapies until they addressed what I understood as physical neuroinflammation, using things such as low-dose naltrexone, phosphatidylserine, DMSO, and so on. My own version is that I can't do any real healing work when I feel like I have toxins in my gut. Ozonated zeolite helps me a lot with that. So does ozonated charcoal water when I feel surrounded by chaotic energy fields, whether I interpret them as EMF or auric.

This is important to me, and it connects with my other articles. I call it neurological de-armoring—not another trauma exercise, but the ground I am asking the exercise to work on. I wrote separate guides on



Overview



Detail